

Project XTC – Development Edition 0.1

Chapter 7 – Scribble Strips: Your Primary Source of Feedback

The small displays above each channel strip are called scribble strips. They are easy to overlook, but they are one of the most informative parts of the X-Touch. As you move around Bitwig, they constantly update to tell you what each channel strip currently represents.

More Than Track Names

When you first connect the X-Touch, the scribble strips usually display track names. That is only the beginning. As you switch modes they may show parameter names, values, send destinations or other context supplied by DrivenByMoss. The display changes because the controller's current task has changed.

Read Before You Reach

One habit separates experienced users from beginners: they read the scribble strip before touching a control. The display tells you exactly what the encoder or fader is about to affect, greatly reducing accidental edits.

Working with Device Mode

Select a track containing a Bitwig device such as Polymer and enter Device Mode. The scribble strips immediately replace track information with parameter names. Without opening the device window, you already know what each V-Pot controls.

When Things Don't Look Right

If the labels change unexpectedly, don't assume there is a fault. Ask yourself: Did I select a different track? Did I change mode? Did I bank to a different group of tracks? In almost every case, the displays are accurately reflecting Bitwig's current state.

Field Note #009

During troubleshooting, the scribble strips are often the quickest way to confirm that the X-Touch and Bitwig are still communicating. If the displays respond to your actions, the control surface is almost certainly connected correctly.

Exercise

Create a project with several tracks and a few Bitwig devices. Move between Mixer Mode, Device Mode and different banks while watching only the scribble strips. Notice how they provide a running commentary on what the controller is currently doing.

Key Takeaways

- Scribble strips provide context, not just labels.
- Read them before adjusting a control.
- Changes in the display usually indicate a change of track, bank or mode.
- They are one of your best troubleshooting tools.

Before You Continue...

The next chapter looks at the motor faders. Having learned how the X-Touch tells you what it is controlling, you'll see how it also shows you what Bitwig is doing in real time.